Ensemble Series

UCF New Music Ensemble

Thad Anderson, director

featuring guest artist

icarus Quartet

November 2, 2023
7:00 p.m.
Rehearsal Hall Auditorium

—Program—

UCF New Music Ensemble
Thad Anderson, Joseph Baroco, Dylan Dragone, Jacob Fogel, Zouri Girten,
Matthew Herzog, Jordan Jones, Isaac Kim, & Kevin Meraz Jimenez

Blurred (2003) — Bill Ryan

[redacted] (2022) — Sebastian Suarez-Solis

Falling Flames (2013) — Finola Merivale

—Intermission—

icarus Quartet
Ellen Hwangbo, Matt Keown, Michael Sheppard, & Jeff Stern

Quartet (2013) — Steve Reich
I. Fast
II. Slow
III. Fast

little things lost* (2022) — Amy Beth Kirsten
i. painted bird

[AL]PATRÓN (2022) — Christian Quiñones

*This piece is made possible by the Chamber Music America Classical Commissioning Program with generous funding provided by The Andrew W. Mellon Foundation and the Chamber Music America Endowment Fund.

Steinway is the official piano of the UCF Music Department
Turn off all cell phones. No flash photography.

—About the Guest Artist—

Like the mythological figure from which it draws its name, the half piano/half percussion **icarus Quartet** dares to fly towards the sun, aspiring to new heights of artistry. Following their Carnegie Hall debut, composer Paul Lansky simply remarked, "This is music making of the highest order." The Wall Street Journal hailed icarus Quartet's 2022 album, *BIG THINGS*, as "a beautifully immersive recording…an impressive calling card."

Winner of the 2019 Chamber Music Yellow Springs Competition, icarus Quartet has given new life to old masterpieces as well as the future of their instrumentation. The quartet was chosen as Chamber Music Northwest's 2020 Protégé Project Ensemble and was subsequently the first ensemble to hold the Klinger ElectroAcoustic Residency at Bowling Green State University. Past engagements include appearances at the Kennedy Center's REACH, the Vienna Summer Music Festival, the Horowitz Piano Series, the Queens New Music Festival, the Adalman Chamber Series, and at Princeton University for a Lansky tribute concert held in honor of the emeritus professor's 75th birthday.

Fostering the development of new works through commissioning and collaborating lies at the core of the group's mission, inspiring partnerships with titans of the classical contemporary field, established artists of electronic and indie music scenes, as well as gifted student composers through their annual "iQ Tests" program. Recent and upcoming collaborators include Amy Beth Kirsten, Nick Zammuto, Viet Cuong, Michael Laurello, Martin Bresnick, and Jennifer Higdon as well as 2023-24 iQ Test Scholars Kian Ravaei and Che Buford. The ensemble's work often extends beyond the realm of music; *Wilderness Suite*, an ongoing intermedia project combining icarus Quartet with the forces of composer Ruby Fulton, geographer Teresa Cavazos-Cohn, and eight independent video artists, examines the unique anti-development of the 2.4 million-acre Frank Church River of No Return Wilderness site through still imagery, data, film, recorded interviews, natural sound samples, and live music.

Passionate about educating and engaging with the next generation of musicians, icarus Quartet thrives in school and university settings. They have given classes on chamber music and composition seminars on writing for their instruments at institutions including the Peabody Conservatory, the University of Massachusetts Amherst, Bridgeport University, the University of Florida, the University of Northern Iowa, Florida State University, Lebanon Valley College, Yale College, Wright State University, and the University of Idaho's Lionel Hampton School of Music, in addition to presentations for grade school and Pre-K students.

The icarus musicians are all celebrated soloists in their own rights, and together they have found a special chemistry and inimitable joy playing chamber music. They are dedicated to the discovery, creation, and performance of new music, but what distinguishes their approach to contemporary music is a strong training and background in the classical genre. icarus Quartet is committed to performing new works with a studied and convincing interpretation that mirrors the validity of works with performance practices developed over centuries.